The Spas of Mystacor

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/59674561.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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The Spas of Mystacor

by TheSofterGentlerMe

Summary

It's been two years and Catra has made a lot of progress with her fears and problems. On a trip to Mystacor though, she's going to face another with Adora's help. Water.

Notes

Shall we?

See the end of the work for more notes

"Why are you doing this to me?" Catra said, taking deep breaths as Adora held her hand.

"You said you wanted to do this," Adora said. "You told me to not let you back out."

"OK, yes, but I lie, you know I lie, I lied to you," Catra said as she fought back the fear thumping in her chest.

"Did you?" Adora said, stopping for a moment.

Catra fought back images of underlit green pools of liquid and took a few deep breaths before shaking her head.

"No, I didn't but I'm telling you now I was wrong," Catra said. "Forget about this."

Adora sat down on the edge of a rock in the Mystacor pool room as she gently stroked Catra's hand.

"Listen, if you really don't want to do this, we can go get a massage or just lay on the beach. You don't have to get in the water. What do you want to do?"

Catra looked down at Adora's feet because it was easier then looking at Adora and seeing one of the pools of water behind her.

"I want to not be scared of water like some kind of weirdo," Catra muttered.

"Hey, stop it," Adora said softly as she raised Catra's hand to her lips and kissed it. "You know you're not a weirdo."

"Then why can't I get in the water?" Catra said.

"You know why," Adora said, not wanting to say it directly. Catra had always disliked water but in the two years since the fall of Prime, Adora had seen it way worse then she'd ever known.

"You've done everything your Listener has told you to do about this. She did say this might take a few times."

Catra let out a little huff of irritation at the mention of the person working her through her many issues in Listening sessions. The other problems they'd worked on had shown progress and Catra was irritated that something this simple was proving to be difficult.

"It was just… it shouldn't be this big a deal," Catra said, feeling the claws on her toes coming out a little and digging into the sandals she was wearing. "I mean, whoopity-doo, it's in the past."

Adora gently set a hand on Catra's hip. She'd wanted to reach up and touch Catra's face but between the ears flicking back, her tail swishing, and the tone in Catra's voice, Adora knew that wasn't a great idea without asking first.

"Really? You really think that?"

Catra let out another irritated huff as she said, "Yes." She looked up to see Adora's skeptical face and looked away again. "Fine, no, are you happy you're right?"

"Come on, it's not like that," Adora said.

After a pause, Catra let out a long sigh as she said, "No, I know it's not. Can we just go back to the room? I know I said ignore me if I try to get out of this but can we, please?"

"Of course," Adora said as she got up and hugged Catra. She felt Catra bury her head into her shoulder and Adora carefully set her hand on the back of Catra's neck. She inadvertently touched the scar there and felt Catra stiffen up and she quickly pulled her hand back. "I'm sorry."

"It's alright," Catra said, her voice muffled but the slight shake in her told Adora it very much wasn't.

"Keep your eyes closed," Adora said. "I'll lead you out, OK?"

There was no response at first and Adora was about to ask again when the shaking got a little worse and she heard Catra start to speak in a low mechanical voice.

"She promised she was going to take me home and she did. She promised she was going to take me home and she did."

"Hey, it's alright, I'm right here, I'm not going anywhere, ever," Adora said, gripping Catra tight. "You're home. We're home."

After a brief pause, she felt Catra shake her head for a moment and start to say in a more normal tone of voice, "I can see Adora's skin, I can see Adora's robe, I can see Adora's hair, I can see Adora's ear, I can see my hair, it's long, it's long, I can feel Adora's robe, I can feel Adora's hair on my knuckles, I…"

It continued on as Catra said some more things she could feel, hear, smell, and taste. As she did, Adora felt the shaking subside until it was gone and Catra finished by taking long deep breaths. Adora gently kissed the top of Catra's head as she said, "You did good."

"No one saw me did they?" Catra said as she straightened up and wiped away tears Adora hadn't known were there.

"No," Adora said. "It doesn't matter if they had. I would have kicked their ass if they'd judged you or even looked twice."

Catra let out a sharp, shaking laugh as she said, "Yes, that's a great idea, Princess."

Adora kissed her briefly before saying, "Ready to go back to the room?"

Catra nodded but turned and stared at the pool a few steps away. A gentle wisp of steam drifted from the still surface.

"It's not cold?"

"What, the water?" Adora asked and Catra nodded. "No, that pool is probably a little above body temp."

"I remember it was cold," Catra said as she backed up a step into Adora, who wrapped her arms around her. "I remember it felt hot right at first but then it was so damn cold."

Catra went silent and Adora waited, feeling like she wasn't done and after a minute, she went on.

"Don't let go of me, not once, OK?"

"Not once, I promise."

Catra looked back at Adora before she took a step forward. Adora, true to her word, walked forward with her, arms wrapped around her. Catra took a few more awkward steps forward and stood at the edge of the pool.

"I got you," Adora whispered and felt Catra squeeze her arm as she carefully stepped forward and sank one foot into the water before yanking it out.

"It's warm," Catra whispered before putting her foot back in, a shudder running through her.

"You don't have to…," Adora started to say before Catra cut her off.

"Don't talk and don't let go," Catra said as she put her other foot in to another shudder.

Adora squeezed her and shuffled in behind her, arms still wrapped around her. They both stood there silently for a moment, the water a little above their ankles, before Catra took a step down onto a lower step, Adora following her, and the water was up to their knees. Catra was shaking still and her muscles were so tense they felt like iron but she made no move to back up. Adora could hear she was muttering something under her breath but it was so

low that Adora couldn't make it out, only that whatever was being said was being repeated over and over.

After a few minutes, Catra carefully pulled Adora's arms apart but kept one of her hands in her own as she said, "Just hold my hand."

When she turned to speak, Adora could see the sharp fear in her eyes but her lips were set tight and she just nodded in response as Catra stepped down, the next step the deepest, putting her into waist deep water and Adora could see she was back to saying whatever it was she'd been saying before as her robe floated for a moment before soaking up the water and sinking back down. Adora followed so she was at the same level and it was then she noticed that the claws on Catra's other hand were fully extended and her hand was curved in a fighting strike but her other hand held Adora's hand as gently as she ever did. She was about to speak up when Catra started speaking louder, still just barely a whisper but loud enough to be heard.

"Fuck him, fuck him, fuck him, fuck him, fuck him…" and then a deep inrushing of breath followed by Catra screaming at the top of her lungs, "FUCK HIM!" and then she disappeared under the water. Adora jumped but didn't let go and a second later, Catra burst out of the water with a whoop and a deep breath of air.

"Are you alright!?" Adora said as Catra frantically pushed her mane out of her face.

"I'm fine! Get me the fuck out of this pool!" Catra said. Adora picked her up and was ready to carry her out when Catra laughed a bit manically. "No! Put me down, just help me get out!"

A few minutes later and they were back in the little changing room they'd been assigned as Catra laughed and cried all at once. Adora had helped her out of the soaked clothes and had got her into the full body dryer and they were both now curled up together on a large divan, wrapped in warm, dry robes.

"Not how I thought that'd go," Catra said as she calmed down a bit more as the tears subsided. "At least I got it done though."

"Really? You seemed to like it so much," Adora said with a little smile and a push.

Catra smiled back at her as she said, "At least I get why you like it so much now."

"Really?" Adora said.

"No," Catra said with a shudder but still smiling as she leaned over and kissed Adora.

End Notes

Not much to say on this one except I expected it to be a bit funnier but then I realized, nope, can't do that. Thanks for reading!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!